

Junior Year Timeline

FILL IN TOGETHER

Month by month through the year that matters most. Junior year is where the transcript, the test scores and the college list are actually built — senior year is mostly paperwork.

When: Print in August before junior year

Autumn term

- ☐ August — check the schedule is the most rigorous the student can genuinely handle
- ☐ September — meet the school counsellor and put a face to the name
- ☐ October — take the PSAT/NMSQT (this is the only route into National Merit)
- ☐ October — start a rough list of careers or subjects of interest
- ☐ November — plan an SAT or ACT date and start real practice
- ☐ December — review first-term grades honestly and adjust

Spring term

- ☐ January — build the first version of a college list
- ☐ February — run net price calculators for three schools to see real numbers
- ☐ February — agree the family budget figure
- ☐ March — sit the SAT or ACT
- ☐ March — ask two teachers for recommendations for the autumn
- ☐ April — visit two or three campuses, including one you can afford
- ☐ April — plan next year's schedule; keep it rigorous
- ☐ May — take any AP or IB exams
- ☐ May — start the activity résumé while it is fresh

Summer after junior year

- ☐ Draft the personal statement — genuinely, not in your head
- ☐ Retake the SAT or ACT if a higher score is realistic
- ☐ Work, volunteer, or shadow someone. Any of the three.
- ☐ Narrow the list to eight to twelve schools
- ☐ Create the Common App account when it opens on 1 August

Our own dates

WORTH KNOWING

- ◆ The PSAT in October of junior year is the only way into National Merit. There is no second chance.
- ◆ A draft essay written in July is worth five written in November.
- ◆ Run one net price calculator early. It changes the list more than any tour.